> prevent child marriages and marriages based on law favourable to one sect, to conduct and encourage love marriages, widow marriages, inter-caste and inter-religious marriages and to have the marriages registered under the Civil Law.[15]

By contrast, in Maharashtra, Gujarat and the so-called ‘cow-belt’ of the Gangetic plains it was the more orthodox and high-caste reformers who began to find their voice, men like the ascetic Dayananda Saraswati, born in Kathiawar, who founded the Arya Samaj Hindu movement as a force for Hindu reform, promoting education and equal rights and condemning such blights as child marriage and the caste system. It was Dayananda who first called for *Swaraj*, and who first used that term in calling for ‘home rule’ for India. But it was also Dayananda who, in his determination to rid Hinduism of what he regarded as idolatrous accretions, called on Hindus to reject Western secular values and return to the golden age of their ancestors under the slogan ‘go back to the Vedas’ – a vision of the Vedic past that infuriated such scholars as the philologist Professor Max Müller, who wrote of Dayananda:

> To him not only was everything contained in the *Vedas* perfect truth, but he went a stage further, and by the most incredible interpretations succeeded in persuading himself and others that everything worth knowing, even in the most recent inventions of modern science, were alluded to in the *Vedas*. Steam-engines, railways, and steam-boats, all were shown, at least in their germs, to the poets of the *Vedas*, for *veda*, he argued, means ‘Divine Knowledge’, and how could anything have been hid from them?’[16]

In 1881 Dayananda published a pamphlet entitled *Gokarunanidhi*, or ‘Ocean of mercy to the cow’, in which he